NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

KEY TOPIC 3 • 1558–1588

Elizabethan Society in the Age of Exploration, 1558–88



HISTORICAL PRIMARY RECORD: A Chief of the Secotan (Carolina Algonquian) (1585) **BRITISH MUSEUM • 1906,0509.1.21 • LONDON**

Key topic 3: Elizabethan society in the Age of Exploration, 1558–88	
1 Education and leisure	• Education in the home and schools. • Sport, pastimes and the theatre.
2 The 'problem' of the poor	• The reasons for the increase in poverty and vagabondage during these years. • The changing attitudes and policies towards the poor.
3 Exploration and voyages of discovery	• Factors prompting exploration, including the impact of new technology on ships and sailing and the drive to expand trade. • The reasons for, and significance of, Drake's circumnavigation of the globe.
4 Attempted colonisation of Virginia	• Reasons for the attempted colonisation of Virginia, including the significance of Raleigh. • Reasons for the failure of the first settlement in Virginia.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 1: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 3)

Instructions: As you study each enquiry lesson, complete the timeline missions by sketching and annotating in the corresponding dual-coding sketchpads below.

1572 • The Vagabonds Act

Key Topic 3.2

Parliament passes the 1572 Vagabonds Act, creating a legal distinction between the 'deserving poor' (elderly and sick) and 'idle beggars'. Vagrants over 14 are whipped and burned through the ear; repeat offenders face execution.

1576 • Act for Relief of the Poor & Burbage Builds 'The Theatre'

Key Topic 3.1

The 1576 Poor Act orders town councils to provide wool and raw materials to put the unemployed to work, creating 'Houses of Correction' (Bridewells). In the same year, actor James Burbage constructs 'The Theatre' in Shoreditch, launching Elizabethan public drama.

DEC 1577 • Drake Departs on Global Circumnavigation

Key Topic 3.3

Sir Francis Drake departs Plymouth with five ships on the *Pelican* (*Golden Hind*). Backed secretly by Elizabeth and investors, his mission is to disrupt Spanish Pacific trade, discover trade routes to the Moluccas, and claim land for the English Crown.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 2: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 3)

Instructions: Complete the dual-coding sketches to permanently anchor these chronological turning points in long-term memory.

SEPT 1580 • Drake Returns to Deptford; Knighted by Elizabeth

Key Topic 3.3

Drake sails the *Golden Hind* into Plymouth Harbour after 33 months, becoming the first Englishman to circumnavigate the globe. His cargo of Spanish bullion yields a 4,700% return for royal investors, and Elizabeth knights him on board in April 1581.

1584–1585 • Raleigh's Patent & The First Roanoke Colony

Key Topic 3.4

Queen Elizabeth grants Sir Walter Raleigh a royal patent to explore and colonise Virginia. In 1585, 107 male colonists sail under Sir Richard Grenville and Ralph Lane to Roanoke Island, seeking gold, privateering bases, and fertile agricultural land.

1587–1590 • The Second Roanoke Colony ("The Lost Colony")

Key Topic 3.4

John White leads 118 settlers, including women and children, to establish a permanent plantation. When White returns in 1590 after being delayed by the Armada, the entire colony has vanished without a trace, leaving only the word "CROATOAN" carved on a post.

Was Elizabethan society truly entering a "Golden Age" of culture and learning?

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • 5 CAUSAL MILESTONES

PUPIL NOTE-TAKING ZONE • *Answer each milestone prompt using evidence from teacher exposition*

1 1558–1580s
Attitudes to Education & Literacy
- Literacy at 30% for Men & 10% for Women
- Petty Schools & Dame Schools for Basics
- Reinforcing Great Chain of Being

Why did Elizabethan attitudes towards social hierarchy limit educational opportunity?

2 1558–1580s
Grammar Schools
- Over Seventy New Endowed Schools Founded
- Latin Grammar & Classical Rhetoric Curriculum
- Social Mobility for Middling Sons

How did grammar schools provide a route for sons of the gentry and merchants to rise in society?

3 1558–1580s
Universities & Noble Education
- Private Tutors in Noble Households
- Oxford & Cambridge College Expansions
- Inns of Court London Legal Training

How did the education of the nobility differ from schooling provided to the middling classes?

4 1558–1580s
Sports and Pastimes by Social Class
- Hunting, Hawking & Fencing for Elites
- Violent Folk Football & Archery for Commoners
- Universal Paris Garden Bear-Baiting

How did leisure pursuits reflect both deep social divisions and shared national culture?

5 1576–1588
Development of the Theatre
- Burbage Builds 'The Theatre' at Shoreditch
- Penny Groundlings Mingle with Box Gentry
- Puritans Condemn Immorality & Plague Risk

Why did the theatre attract enormous popularity while provoking intense Puritan opposition?

"The Theatre (1576): The first permanent playhouse in London, built outside the city walls in Shoreditch."

Question 1 Practice: Describe Three Key Features [3 × 2 marks • 9 mins]

Total Score: [/ 6]

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS] ★ HIGH PROBABILITY

Edexcel June 2018 (Q1a)

Describe one key feature of education in Elizabethan Grammar Schools.

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS] ★ HIGH PROBABILITY

Edexcel June 2019 (Q1a)

Describe one key feature of the Elizabethan theatre.

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

• QUESTION 1(C): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

HIGH-YIELD SPECIFICATION FOCUS

Edexcel Specification Focus

Describe one key feature of sports and pastimes in Elizabethan England.

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 2). In Milestone 2, sketch James Burbage's wooden playhouse and the quill pen of a grammar school scholar.

← Pages 2–3

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 18 mins]

EDEXCEL JUNE 2022 (Q2) | CORE SPECIFICATION FOCUS | Score: [/ 12]

Explain why there was a significant expansion in education in Elizabethan England.

You may use in your answer: • Grammar schools • The Protestant Reformation *(You must also use information of your own.)*

1. CAUSE 1: RENAISSANCE HUMANISM & TRADE — POINT 1	2. CAUSE 2: PROTESTANT REFORMATION & BIBLE STUDY — POINT 2	3. CAUSE 3: EXPANSION OF ENDOWED GRAMMAR SCHOOLS — POINT 3
Explain that the Renaissance emphasized that education was essential for success; growing international trade and bureaucracy required literate merchants, lawyers, clerks, and estate stewards.	Explain that Protestant theology insisted that every Christian must be able to read the English Bible to achieve personal salvation; literacy was viewed as a sacred religious duty.	Explain that wealthy merchants and gentry established over 70 new grammar schools, endowing scholarships so that bright boys from humble backgrounds could attend without paying fees.

Task: *Using the structure strip above, write your analytical response below (continue on facing page for full timed response):*

"Extended writing: analyse how Elizabethan education reinforced rigid social class hierarchies."

MARGIN	*[Extended Writing Continued • Paragraph 2/3 & Final Sustained Conclusion]*

Was Elizabethan poverty caused by personal idleness or unstoppable economic forces?

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • 5 CAUSAL MILESTONES

PUPIL NOTE-TAKING ZONE • *Answer each milestone prompt using evidence from teacher exposition*

1 **1558–1580s**

Population Growth & Rising Prices

- Population Surges from 3m to Over 4m
- Consecutive Bad Harvests Inflate Grain Prices
- Falling Real Wages for Farm Labourers

How did the relationship between population growth and food supply generate severe poverty?

2 **1558–1580s**

Changes in Farming: Enclosure & Sheep

- Wool Accounts for 80% of English Exports
- Hedging Common Land for Low-Labour Flocks
- Eviction of Strip-Farming Tenant Cottagers

Why did the expansion of sheep farming cause widespread rural unemployment and eviction?

3 **1558–1570s**

Changing Attitudes to the Poor

- Harman's Caveat for Common Cursitors Book
- Impotent Poor Versus Sturdy Beggars
- Dread of Social Unrest & Treasonous Riot

Why did Elizabethan authorities draw such a sharp distinction between the 'deserving' and 'idle' poor?

4 **1572**

The 1572 Vagabonds Act

- Compulsory Parish Poor Rate Tax
- Overseers Appointed to Distribute Relief
- Ear-Boring with Hot Iron for Repeat Vagrants

How did the 1572 Act combine harsh criminal punishment with the first compulsory tax for relief?

5 **1576**

The 1576 Act for Relief of the Poor

- Parishes Provide Raw Wool, Flax & Hemp
- County Bridewells Compel Hard Labour
- Foundation for Comprehensive 1601 Poor Law

Why did the 1576 Act represent a major shift in the state's responsibility for unemployment?

"Poverty grew because population rose from 3m to 4m, while wool enclosure eliminated farm jobs."

Question 1 Practice: Describe Three Key Features [3 × 2 marks • 9 mins]

Total Score: [/ 6]

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

★ HIGH PROBABILITY

Edexcel November 2021 (Q1a)

Describe one key feature of the enclosure of land in Elizabethan England.

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

★ HIGH PROBABILITY (Never examined)

Edexcel June 2023 (Q1a)

Describe one key feature of the 1576 Act for the Relief of the Poor.

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

• QUESTION 1(C): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

HIGH-YIELD SPECIFICATION FOCUS

Edexcel Specification Focus

Describe one key feature of the distinction between the 'deserving' and 'idle' poor.

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 1). In Milestone 1, sketch the sheep shears and the ear-boring branding iron from the 1572 Act.

← Pages 2–3

Question 3: Evaluative Essay [16 marks + 4 SPaG • 25 mins]

EDEXCEL NOVEMBER 2020 (Q3B) | ★ HIGH-YIELD FORECAST | Score: [/ 20]

'The enclosure of land was the main reason for the dramatic increase in poverty in Elizabethan England.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

You may use in your answer: • Sheep farming • Population growth ***(You must also use information of your own.)***

1. CRITERIA 1: ENCLOSURE & RURAL EVICTIONS — POINT 1	2. CRITERIA 2: POPULATION SURGE & INFLATION — POINT 2	3. CRITERIA 3: HARVEST FAILURES & MONASTERY LOSS — POINT 3
Explain how enclosing common fields for sheep grazing removed arable strip farming; because wool needed few shepherds, whole villages were depopulated, forcing dispossessed cottagers into vagrancy.	Explain that England's population surged from 3m to over 4m; higher demand drove up food and bread prices (inflation) while creating a labour surplus that depressed wages below subsistence level.	Explain that the dissolution of monasteries had eliminated traditional Catholic charity networks; when bad harvests struck, famine pushed marginal farmworkers into absolute starvation.

Task: *Using the structure strip above, write your analytical response below (continue on facing page for full timed response):*

"Sustained response: distinguish clearly between the Impotent Poor and Sturdy Beggars."

MARGIN	*[Extended Writing Continued • Paragraph 2/3 & Final Sustained Conclusion]*

Was English maritime exploration driven by scientific curiosity or ruthless economic greed?

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • 5 CAUSAL MILESTONES

PUPIL NOTE-TAKING ZONE • *Answer each milestone prompt using evidence from teacher exposition*

1 1558–1575
New Navigational Technology
- Astrolabes & Quadrants Measure Latitude
- Mercator Projection Global Maps (1569)
- Navigation Away from Known Coastlines

How did advances in navigational science make oceanic exploration feasible for English captains?

2 1558–1577
Improvements in Ship Design
- Low Forecastles & Triangular Lateen Sails
- Culverin Cannons on Four-Wheel Carriages
- Manoeuvrable Tacking in Severe Atlantic Weather

How did changes in galleon design and gun placement give English sailors an advantage at sea?

3 1550s–1570s
The Search for New Trade Routes
- Collapse of Antwerp Cloth Market (1550s)
- Muscovy & Levant Joint-Stock Companies
- Frobisher & Davis Arctic Northwest Search

Why did English merchants establish joint-stock companies to explore new global trade routes?

4 1577–1580
Drake's Circumnavigation
- Pelican Renamed Golden Hind at Horn
- Strait of Magellan Gale Storm Survival
- Claims Nova Albion (California) for Crown

Why was Drake's voyage through the Strait of Magellan and across the Pacific an extraordinary achievement?

5 1580–1588
Significance of Drake's Voyage
- £140,000 Spanish Bullion Cargo Returns
- 4,700% Financial Profit Pays Crown Debt
- Proves England Can Challenge Spanish Seas

How did the success of Drake's circumnavigation alter England's position on the world stage?

"New navigation tech: The astrolabe measured stars, but Drake's daring navigated the globe."

Question 1 Practice: Describe Three Key Features [3 × 2 marks • 9 mins]

Total Score: [/ 6]

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

MEDIUM FREQUENCY

Edexcel June 2022 (Q1b)

Describe one key feature of the new navigational technology used by Elizabethan explorers.

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

RECENT EXAM BOARD FOCUS

Edexcel June 2024 (Q1b)

Describe one key feature of Francis Drake's circumnavigation (1577–80).

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

• QUESTION 1(C): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

HIGH-YIELD SPECIFICATION FOCUS

Edexcel Specification Focus

Describe one key feature of the search for the Northwest Passage.

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 3). In Milestone 3, sketch the astrolabe dial and the globe encircled by Drake's sailing route.

← Pages 2–3

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 18 mins]

EDEXCEL NOVEMBER 2021 (Q2) | ★ HIGH-YIELD FORECAST | Score: [/ 12]

Explain why English exploration by sea increased so rapidly between 1558 and 1588.

You may use in your answer: • New navigational technology • The cloth trade collapse *(You must also use information of your own.)*

1. CAUSE 1: ECONOMIC CRISIS & NEW MARKETS POINT 1

Explain that the collapse of the Antwerp cloth market in the 1550s devastated England's wool trade, forcing merchants to seek new trade routes to Russia (Muscovy Company), the Mediterranean, and the Americas.

2. CAUSE 2: TECHNOLOGICAL & CARTOGRAPHIC ADVANCE POINT 2

Explain that astrolabes, magnetic compasses, Mercator maps, and larger, multi-masted galleons enabled safe transatlantic voyages, transforming open-ocean navigation from suicide into a calculated commercial risk.

3. CAUSE 3: PRIVATEERING WEALTH & SPANISH RIVALRY POINT 3

Explain that plundering Spanish bullion ships in the Americas offered astronomical wealth; Elizabeth and courtiers secretly invested in voyages to challenge Philip II's monopoly and finance the Crown.

Task: *Using the structure strip above, write your analytical response below (continue on facing page for full timed response):*

MARGIN	*[Extended Writing Continued • Paragraph 2/3 & Final Sustained Conclusion]*

Why did Walter Raleigh's dream of an English empire in Virginia end in total catastrophe?

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • 5 CAUSAL MILESTONES

PUPIL NOTE-TAKING ZONE • *Answer each milestone prompt using evidence from teacher exposition*

1 1584
Raleigh's Patent & Planning
- Six-Year Patent to Claim Uncharted Land
- Hakluyt's Discourse on Western Planting
- Privateering Base to Intercept Spanish Plate

Why did Raleigh and the Elizabethan court believe an American colony was vital to England?

2 1584–1585
Recruiting Colonists & Leaders
- 107 Gentlemen Soldiers & No Farmers
- Grenville Fleet & Ralph Lane Army Discipline
- Manteo & Wanchese Native Translators

Why did the social composition and skills of the 1585 colonists create severe vulnerabilities?

3 1585–1586
The First Roanoke Colony & Disaster
- Flagship Tiger Runs Aground on Sandbar
- Seawater Ruins Grain Seeds & Provisions
- Disastrous Reliance on Secotan Fish Weirs

How did environmental accidents and food dependency undermine the first Roanoke settlement?

4 1586
Conflict & Evacuation
- Silver Cup Dispute Leads to Village Burning
- Ralph Lane Ambush Kills Chief Wingina
- Drake Arrives to Evacuate Starving Settlers

Why did armed conflict with the Secotan force the complete abandonment of the 1585 colony?

5 1587–1590
The 'Lost Colony' & Significance
- 118 Civilian Settlers Led by John White
- Armada Impounds Supply Ships in England
- 'CROATOAN' Carved on Deserted Palisade

What crucial lessons did the failure of the Roanoke expeditions provide for future English colonies?

"Walter Raleigh planned the Virginia colony from London; he never actually set foot in Roanoke himself."

Question 1 Practice: Describe Three Key Features [3 × 2 marks • 9 mins]

Total Score: [/ 6]

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

★ HIGH PROBABILITY (Never examined) | ★ High-Yield Forecast (Q1a)

Describe one key feature of Sir Walter Raleigh's royal patent for Virginia (1584).

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

RECENT EXAM BOARD FOCUS | Edexcel June 2023 (Q1b)

Describe one key feature of the failure of the first Roanoke colony (1585–86).

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

• QUESTION 1(C): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

HIGH-YIELD SPECIFICATION FOCUS | Edexcel Specification Focus

Describe one key feature of the 'Lost Colony' of Roanoke (1587–90).

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 6). In Milestone 6, sketch the wooden palisade post carved with "CROATOAN" and the sinking flagship *Tiger*.

← Pages 2–3

Question 3: Evaluative Essay [16 marks + 4 SPaG • 25 mins]

EDEXCEL JUNE 2018 (Q3A) | **★ HIGH-YIELD FORECAST** | **Score: [/ 20]**

'Poor planning and unsuitable colonists were the main reasons why the attempt to colonise Virginia failed in 1585–86.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

You may use in your answer: • Lack of farming skills • Relations with Native Americans *(You must also use information of your own.)*

1. CRITERIA 1: UNSUITABLE SETTLERS & POOR PLANNING **POINT 1**

Explain that the 107 settlers were mostly aristocratic soldiers seeking quick gold rather than farmers; they lacked agricultural skills, refused physical manual labour, and brought inadequate seeds.

2. CRITERIA 2: BAD LUCK & VOYAGE ACCIDENTS **POINT 2**

Explain that the flagship *Tiger* ran aground on a sandbank off Roanoke, flooding the hold with seawater and destroying all grain seeds; settlers arrived too late in the season to plant crops before winter.

3. CRITERIA 3: HOSTILITY WITH NATIVE TRIBES **POINT 3**

Explain that Ralph Lane's brutal military temperament alienated Chief Wingina's Secotan tribe; when an English silver cup went missing, settlers burned a village, leading to open war and starvation.

Task: *Using the structure strip above, write your analytical response below (continue on facing page for full timed response):*

"Independent practice: analyse the three core reasons for the collapse of the 1585 Roanoke colony."

MARGIN	*[Extended Writing Continued • Paragraph 2/3 & Final Sustained Conclusion]*

⭐ GRADE 9 MASTERCLASS: CAUSATION ESSAY • KEY TOPIC 3

EDEXCEL JUNE 2022 · PAPER 2 | **LEVEL 4 EXEMPLAR • 12/12 MARKS**

OFFICIAL EXAM QUESTION • QUESTION 2 [12 MARKS • 18 MINS] — AO1 (6m Knowledge & Understanding) + AO2 (6m Causation & Analysis)

Explain why the problem of poverty and vagrancy increased in the years 1558–88.

You may use in your answer: • Enclosure • Population growth ***(You must also use information of your own.)***

ACTIVE MODEL ANNOTATION PROTOCOL: 🟠 1. Highlight 3 historical facts / statistics | 🔵 2. Underline 3 causal connective links | 🟢 3. Circle where own knowledge beyond stimulus begins

CONTINUOUS PROSE LEVEL 4 EXEMPLAR RESPONSE (FULL MARKS • 12/12)

Notice: Every paragraph opens with a factor, gives precise evidence, and ends with a direct causal link.

PARAGRAPH 1 • STIMULUS 1 A fundamental cause of increasing poverty and vagrancy was explosive population growth. Between 1558 and 1588, England's population grew rapidly from roughly 3 million to over 4.2 million. Agricultural food production could not keep pace with this demographic surge, creating chronic food shortages that drove runaway inflation, particularly in bread prices. Concurrently, the massive influx of young labourers saturated the rural job market, depressing real wages while grasping landowners dramatically increased entry fines and rents. Millions of ordinary Englishmen were reduced to subsistence poverty, unable to afford basic nourishment.

PARAGRAPH 2 • STIMULUS 2 This crisis was aggravated by agrarian restructuring, predominantly the enclosure of common land for sheep farming. Traditional open-field arable farming supported entire village communities through labour-intensive crop cultivation. However, the immense profitability of the wool trade incentivised landlords to enclose common pastures with hedges and convert arable fields into private sheep pasture. Sheep farming required only a tiny fraction of the labour force needed for arable crops, resulting in the widespread eviction of tenant farmers and cottagers. Deprived of common grazing rights, thousands of dispossessed families were driven onto the roads as destitute vagrants.

PARAGRAPH 3 • OWN KNOWLEDGE Beyond the stimulus, poverty worsened severely due to the catastrophic collapse of the European cloth trade and consecutive harvest failures. Woollen cloth accounted for over 80% of England's exports. In the 1550s and 1560s, religious warfare in the Netherlands and trade disputes with Philip II caused the Antwerp cloth market to crash, causing mass unemployment among spinners, carders, and weavers across East Anglia and the West Country. When combined with consecutive disastrous harvests in the 1570s and 1580s, bread prices spiked beyond reach, forcing thousands of impoverished townspeople to turn to begging and criminality to survive.

EXAMINER COMPARISON • WHY MOST PUPILS DROP MARKS ON QUESTION 2

⚠️ **The Level 2 Narrative Trap (4–6 / 12 Marks):**
Pupils write descriptive accounts of Tudor beggar types: "Vagabonds wandered the roads. Counterfeit cranks put soap in their mouths to pretend they were foaming sick. Parliament passed laws to whip vagrants and burn holes through their ears." This describes symptoms and punishments rather than analyzing economic causes.

🎯 **The Level 4 Analytical Standard (10–12 / 12 Marks):**
Categorises socio-economic causation into structural demographic pressure (population surge vs food supply), agrarian structural change (enclosure for sheep farming destroying rural employment), and macroeconomic trade shocks (Antwerp cloth collapse). Explains why parish charity was overwhelmed.

✍️ **PUPIL ACTION • DRAFT YOUR OWN ANALYTICAL CONCLUSION [2 SENTENCES]**

State which factor was the primary driver of Elizabethan poverty and explain your reasoning in 2 sentences:

"The Globe Theatre Blueprint: The Heavens above, the Pit below, and the Tiring House backstage."

UNSEEN SYNOPTIC EXAM PRACTICE • KEY TOPIC 3

PEARSON EDEXCEL SPECIFICATION
SAMS · PAPER 2

Timed Condition: 18 Mins

Score: [/ 12]

QUESTION 2 • EXPLAIN WHY [12 MARKS • AO1 (6M) + AO2 (6M)]

Write 3 analytical paragraphs with sustained causal links to the stem

Explain why English exploration by sea expanded so rapidly in the years 1558–88.

You may use in your answer: • Navigational technology • New trade routes ***(You must also use information of your own.)***

PARAGRAPH 1 (STIMULUS 1) PLAN

Factor 1 · Navigational Advances: Adoption of the astrolabe and quadrant for latitude calculations; magnetic compasses; Mercator projection nautical charts; Hawkins' race-built galleons.

PARAGRAPH 2 (STIMULUS 2) PLAN

Factor 2 · Commercial Need for Markets: Antwerp cloth market collapsed in 1550s/60s; English wool merchants forced to seek new export markets; Muscovy Company (Russia) and Levant Company.

PARAGRAPH 3 (OWN KNOWLEDGE) CRUCIAL

Factor 3 · Own Knowledge (Crucial): Privateering Riches & Imperial Geopolitics; Royal patronage and unofficial investment from Elizabeth; Drake's 1577–80 circumnavigation returning £140,000; challenging Spanish Catholic hegemony.

MARGIN	*[Begin your 3-paragraph timed causation response here...]*

Level Descriptors:	[ ] L1 (1–3m): Basic / Descriptive	[ ] L2 (4–6m): Simple Explanation	[ ] L3 (7–9m): Developed Analysis	[ ] L4 (10–12m): Sustained Causal Judgement	**Final Mark: [/ 12]**

"From Deserving Poor to Idle Vagabonds: Elizabethan Poor Laws laid the foundation for 250 years of welfare."

Cumulative Specification Recall: Enquiries 3.1 & 3.2

Classroom Protocol: Complete 5–10 questions as a Do Now bell-ringer at the start of each lesson, or quiz yourself across the term. Tick the review checkboxes (**R1, R2, R3**) after each spaced retrieval attempt.

ENQUIRY 3.1: EDUCATION AND LEISURE [/ 10]

1. What basic elementary schools taught reading, writing, and arithmetic to young children? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

2. Which fee-paying secondary schools taught Latin, Greek, and rhetoric to middle-class boys? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

3. Did girls attend grammar schools or universities in Elizabethan England? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

4. Which two universities existed in England during Elizabeth's reign? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

5. What violent blood sports were popular with both ordinary people and the nobility? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

6. What name was given to theatergoers who paid 1 penny to stand in the unroofed pit? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

7. Who built London's first permanent public playhouse, 'The Theatre', in 1576? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

8. Which famous Southwark playhouse was built by Shakespeare's company in 1599? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

9. Why did the Puritan-led City of London Corporation oppose theatres? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

10. What aristocratic playing company was patronized by Elizabeth's favourite Robert Dudley? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

ENQUIRY 3.2: THE PROBLEM OF POVERTY [/ 10]

11. Approximately what was England's population in 1558 compared to 1603? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

12. What term describes fencing off open peasant farmland into enclosed fields for sheep grazing? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

13. Why did landowners prefer sheep farming to arable farming with grain crops? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

14. What economic term describes continuous rising prices of food and goods? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

15. What catastrophic weather disaster caused food shortages and rocketing grain prices in the 1590s? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

16. What term described the elderly, orphans, and disabled poor who were unable to work? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

17. What term described fit, healthy beggars who were assumed to be deliberately lazy? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

18. What punishment was imposed on sturdy beggars under the 1572 Vagabonds Act? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

19. What institutions were created by the 1576 Poor Act to punish idle beggars with hard labour? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

20. What local parish tax paid for the relief of the impotent poor? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

"Grade 9 Rule: In 12-mark questions, link your causes! Enclosure caused unemployment, which caused vagrancy."

Cumulative Specification Recall: Enquiries 3.3 & 3.4

Spaced Retention Target: Test yourself on previous weeks' topics before starting a new enquiry. Frequent low-stakes retrieval prevents forgetting and secures Level 4 factual precision.

ENQUIRY 3.3: EXPLORATION AND VOYAGES OF DISCOVERY [/ 10]

21. Which navigation instrument measured the angle of the sun and stars to calculate latitude? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

22. What magnetic Chinese navigational tool allowed Elizabethan ships to steer accurate compass headings? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

23. What new 1569 map projection allowed navigators to plot straight sailing courses across oceans? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

24. Which valuable Asian commodities drove European explorers to find sea routes to the East? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

25. What was the original name of Sir Francis Drake's flagship before he renamed it *Golden Hind*? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

26. Through which notoriously dangerous strait at the tip of South America did Drake sail in 1578? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

27. What name did Drake give to the Californian coast he claimed for Queen Elizabeth in 1579? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

28. In which Indonesian spice islands did Drake trade with the Sultan of Ternate for cloves? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

29. How long did Drake's circumnavigation take from departure to return? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

30. What percentage profit did Drake's voyage generate for Queen Elizabeth and his investors? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

ENQUIRY 3.4: RALEIGH AND VIRGINIA [/ 10]

31. Which Elizabethan courtier and explorer was granted a royal patent to colonise Virginia in 1584? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

32. Why was the new North American territory named 'Virginia' by the English? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

33. Did Sir Walter Raleigh ever travel to Virginia himself? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

34. On which barrier island off modern North Carolina was the first English colony established in 1585? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

35. Which two Native Americans were brought back to London in 1584 to advise the English? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

36. Who was appointed governor of the first 1585 Roanoke settlement? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

37. What catastrophic accident happened to the flagship *Tiger* that destroyed the colonists' food seeds? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

38. Who commanded the English relief fleet that evacuated the starving colonists in 1586? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

39. Who was appointed governor of the second 1587 settlement ("The Lost Colony")? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

40. What single word carved on a wooden palisade post was found when John White returned in 1590? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

QUICK-CHECK ANSWER KEY • KEY TOPIC 3 SYNOPTIC VAULT (QUESTIONS 1–40)

Enquiry 3.1 (Q1–10): **1.** Petty schools (or Dame schools) • **2.** Grammar schools • **3.** No (girls were educated at home in domestic needlework and household management) • **4.** Oxford and Cambridge • **5.** Bear-baiting and cock-fighting • **6.** Groundlings (or penny stinkards) • **7.** James Burbage • **8.** The Globe Theatre • **9.** They believed plays spread plague, promoted sin and immorality, and lured apprentices from work • **10.** The Earl of Leicester's Men

Enquiry 3.2 (Q11–20): **11.** Roughly 3 million in 1558, rising to over 4 million by 1603 (35% increase) • **12.** Enclosure • **13.** Wool was highly profitable and sheep required far fewer agricultural labourers • **14.** Inflation (price rise) • **15.** Consecutive bad harvests • **16.** The Impotent Poor (or Deserving Poor) • **17.** The Sturdy Beggars (or Idle/Undeserving Poor) • **18.** Whipped and burned through the gristle of the right ear with a hot iron • **19.** Houses of Correction (Bridewells) • **20.** The Poor Rate

Enquiry 3.3 (Q21–30): **21.** The Astrolabe (or Quadrant) • **22.** The Magnetic Compass • **23.** The Mercator Projection • **24.** Spices (pepper, cloves, nutmeg) and silk • **25.** *The Pelican* • **26.** The Strait of Magellan • **27.** Nova Albion (New Britain) • **28.** The Moluccas (Spice Islands) • **29.** Nearly three years (December 1577 – September 1580) • **30.** 4,700% profit

Enquiry 3.4 (Q31–40): **31.** Sir Walter Raleigh • **32.** In honour of Elizabeth I, the "Virgin Queen" • **33.** No (he organized and funded the expeditions from England) • **34.** Roanoke Island • **35.** Manteo and Wanchese • **36.** Ralph Lane • **37.** It ran aground on a sandbar, letting seawater flood the hold and ruin the grain • **38.** Sir Francis Drake • **39.** John White • **40.** CROATOAN

Rotate booklet 180° to self-mark retrieval drills in green pen

"Timed Condition Challenge: Structure your points with Point, Fact, Explanation, and Causal Link."

PUPIL: _____ **TARGET GRADE:** [ ] **PREDICTED:** [ ] **ATTITUDE:** 1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5

MASTER EXAM PRACTICE & HOMEWORK ASSESSMENT TRACKER • KEY TOPIC 3

#	ENQUIRY & SPECIFICATION TOPIC	PAGE	EXAM PRACTICE QUESTION & FOCUS	HOMEWORK DEADLINE	MARK AWARDED
3.1	ENQUIRY 3.1: EDUCATION AND LEISURE Do Now Retrieval (p. 4): [/ 10]	p. 5	**Q1(a) Feature:** education in Elizabethan Grammar Schools [2m]	[___/___]	[/ 2]
		p. 5	**Q1(b) Feature:** the Elizabethan theatre [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 5	**Q1(c) Feature:** sports and pastimes in Elizabethan England [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 5	**Q2 Explain Why:** Explain why there was a significant expansion in education in Eliza... [12m]		[/ 12]
3.2	ENQUIRY 3.2: THE PROBLEM OF POVERTY Do Now Retrieval (p. 8): [/ 10]	p. 9	**Q1(a) Feature:** the enclosure of land in Elizabethan England [2m]	[___/___]	[/ 2]
		p. 9	**Q1(b) Feature:** the 1576 Act for the Relief of the Poor [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 9	**Q1(c) Feature:** the distinction between the 'deserving' and 'idle' poor [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 9	**Q3 Essay:** 'The enclosure of land was the main reason for the dramatic increas... [16m]		[/ 16]
3.3	ENQUIRY 3.3: EXPLORATION AND VOYAGES OF DISCOVERY Do Now Retrieval (p. 12): [/ 10]	p. 13	**Q1(a) Feature:** the new navigational technology used by Elizabethan explorers [2m]	[___/___]	[/ 2]
		p. 13	**Q1(b) Feature:** Francis Drake's circumnavigation (1577–80) [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 13	**Q1(c) Feature:** the search for the Northwest Passage [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 13	**Q2 Explain Why:** Explain why English exploration by sea increased so rapidly between... [12m]		[/ 12]
3.4	ENQUIRY 3.4: RALEIGH AND VIRGINIA Do Now Retrieval (p. 16): [/ 10]	p. 17	**Q1(a) Feature:** Sir Walter Raleigh's royal patent for Virginia (1584) [2m]	[___/___]	[/ 2]
		p. 17	**Q1(b) Feature:** the failure of the first Roanoke colony (1585–86) [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 17	**Q1(c) Feature:** the 'Lost Colony' of Roanoke (1587–90) [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 17	**Q3 Essay:** 'Poor planning and unsuitable colonists were the main reasons why t... [16m]		[/ 16]

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ENQUIRY 3.1
Education and leisure
Education in schools and universities &bu...

LESSON — Read Online
20-Q QUIZ — Self-Marking

Quiz Attempt: [ ] 1st [ ] 2nd [ ] 3rd
Score: [/ 20] Date: ___/___

ENQUIRY 3.2
The Problem of Poverty
Reasons for the increase in poverty and v...

LESSON — Read Online
20-Q QUIZ — Self-Marking

Quiz Attempt: [ ] 1st [ ] 2nd [ ] 3rd
Score: [/ 20] Date: ___/___

ENQUIRY 3.3
Exploration and voyages of disco...
Factors prompting exploration • new ...

LESSON — Read Online
20-Q QUIZ — Self-Marking

Quiz Attempt: [ ] 1st [ ] 2nd [ ] 3rd
Score: [/ 20] Date: ___/___

ENQUIRY 3.4
Raleigh and Virginia
Sir Walter Raleigh and the attempt to col...

LESSON — Read Online
20-Q QUIZ — Self-Marking

Quiz Attempt: [ ] 1st [ ] 2nd [ ] 3rd
Score: [/ 20] Date: ___/___